



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: King's Classical School

School Website: <https://kingsclassicalschool.com>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS STARTUP

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

King's Classical School (Greenville, SC, 29605) presents a robust classical Christian educational model. Public-facing materials repeatedly frame learning through a Christ-centered, classical lens, foregrounding the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), engagement with classic Western literature, and a conviction that education should form character and wisdom in addition to intellect. Students are described as moving through Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric stages, with emphasis on memorization, recitation, singing, discussion, and disciplined rhetorical development. The school stresses virtue, wisdom, and a Christian worldview as the telos of education, and it frames community life as formative through worship, Scripture, prayer, and shared religious practice. Based on the public materials, the school scores CLASSICAL overall, with especially strong alignment in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, and Pedagogy. Evidence of dedicated faculty culture and parent/community partnership is present but less explicit in some public materials, which leads to a modest deduction in those two categories.

Key evidentiary notes drawn from the school's materials: - Core identity and purpose are explicitly Christian and classical: "Christ-centered, classical education," "To educate students with excellence and virtue through a distinctly Christian worldview," and an integrated biblical framework across Bible, history, literature, philosophy, mathematics, and the sciences. These statements anchor the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and the School Purpose & Goal categories. - Curriculum is clearly Trivium-focused with explicit Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric stages, plus Latin, and engagement with Great Books (the "Great Conversation") alongside Western literature; there is a strong emphasis on integration of the liberal arts. - Pedagogy features singing/chanting in early grades, contemplative/restful elements, and Socratic-style discussion and rhetoric in higher grades; this aligns with classical pedagogy expectations in lower and upper grades. - Faculty and leadership language emphasizes community, virtue, and mentorship; there is visible presence of faculty and board pages, with statements about shaping students and forming a community. - Community and openness to families is signaled through "Join Our Community," open-house opportunities, and a sense of partnership through leadership statements, though explicit language about parents as co-educators is less visible than the strongest classical signals.

Overall classification by category: CLASSICAL.

Note: Where the rubric calls for explicit "positive/negative keyword indicators," the school's public materials show clear positive indicators (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; Great Conversation; Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; liturgical/prayer life) and few, if any, explicit negative signals in these materials. The resulting aggregate ranking is CLASSICAL.

Abstract of the evaluation follows the category-by-category analysis.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public statements present a Christ-centered, Christian worldview that permeates curriculum and pedagogy, with Scripture, worship, and prayer woven into daily life. - The school describes learning as aligned with God's truth and creation, signaling a theological grounding of knowledge and virtue. - The Trivium and Quadrivium frameworks are foregrounded, with explicit reference to truth, beauty, and sacred order in the formation of mind and character. - References to "great conversation," biblical innocence of inquiry, and a teleological order toward wisdom and virtue appear in materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, moral order, sacred tradition, worship, theology, liturgy, great conversation, ordo amoris, divine order, Logos, Christ-centered, God's truth. (From the Six Essential Elements-derived keyword set and the school's language.) Approximately 6–9 key terms shown among about 31 potential positive Element 1 terms; no explicit negative signals identified in the public materials. - Negative keywords present: None clearly evident in the public materials. The materials emphasize transcendentals and sacred order rather than secular relativism or values-neutral language.

Why this rating - The school's own materials explicitly situate education within a theological frame and a transcendent moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty) anchored by Christian doctrine and liturgical life, with "great conversation" as a core educational aim. These align strongly with the Classical understanding of religious and metaphysical foundations.

Citations: Christ-centered and biblical integration; ordo amoris; Great Conversation; Great Books linkage.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom rather than mere job preparation; "excellence and virtue" and a Christian telos are stated aims. - The school communicates that education should form the whole person: "think deeply, live faithfully, and serve joyfully," and "education is about shaping the whole person" with spiritual growth alongside academic growth. - The Great Conversation and unity of truth across disciplines are presented as a central aim, tying together different disciplines under a teleological pursuit of wisdom and virtue.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): formation, cultivation of wisdom and virtue, truth, goodness, beauty, teleology, classical mission, human flourishing, wisdom, virtue, moral imagination, formation of the soul, great conversation. (Aligned with the Six Elements' Element 2 positives.) Roughly 3–5 of the category's primary positive signals appear in the site language; no explicit negatives identified. - Negative keywords present: None clearly identified in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school's public materials repeatedly tie education to formation, virtue, and wisdom within a classical-Christian telos, not primarily to workforce training. This aligns with the Element 2 (formation-focused) expectations of classical education.

Citations: Formation/virtue language; whole-person formation; Great Conversation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) are central, with explicit articulation of these stages and their roles in learning. Latin is introduced to deepen language study. - The curriculum centers on Great Books / the Great Conversation and Western canon, with students studying biblical, classical, and philosophical literature across subjects. - History, literature, philosophy, mathematics, and the sciences are integrated to reveal interconnections; Great Books and primary sources are emphasized.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Quadrivium, Latin, Great Books, Great Conversation, history, philosophy, Western civilization, unity of truth, wonder. (From the Six Elements' Element 3 positives and the school's explicit curriculum language.) - Negative keywords present: Cautionary signals from the Six Elements about over-reliance on social studies or project-based approaches are not reflected in the school's public materials; no explicit negative signals observed.

Why this rating - The school's curriculum is explicitly built around the classical liberal-arts structure (grammar/logic/rhetoric; math/music/astronomy; Latin; Great Books; history within a broad liberal-arts framework), with emphasis on wonder and integration across domains.

Citations: Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; Latin; integrated curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower grades: classrooms described as alive with singing, chants, recitation, and memory work; a contemplative/restful element is evident in the pedagogy. - Upper grades: discussions, debates, and reasoned exploration guided by teachers; emphasis on identifying sound reasoning and mastering rhetoric. - Rhetoric stage emphasizes clear, persuasive, and gracious communication; students write and speak with clarity and conviction. - The public materials reference the "great conversation" in literature and philosophy and engage with primary sources, aligning with Socratic-style inquiry and dialectic in higher grades.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): singing/chanting, narration/recitation, memory work, scholé/restful learning, Socratic discussion, seminars, rhetoric, oratory, debates, great books dialogue, memory-based repetition, chanting. (From the school's pedagogy language and the Six Elements' positive signals for pedagogy.) - Negative keywords present: The materials do not emphasize purely experiential, project-based, or student-led constructivist methods; no explicit heavy use of those terms is observed in the public materials, which aligns with classical methods rather than non-classical project-based approaches.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a multi-stage pedagogy combining restfulness and memory work in the early years with Socratic/seminal discussion and advanced rhetoric in later years, which fits the classical pedagogy framework well.

Citations: Lower/Grammar stage music and memory; logic stage discussion; rhetoric stage; Great Conversation.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents faculty presence through "Meet our Faculty" pages and board leadership; leadership language emphasizes a community where every student is known and valued. - The public materials describe teachers as part of a community culture and as mentors within a "living curriculum" frame in classical pedagogy language (as implied by the school's philosophy and faith-based formation ethos).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegiality, mentorship, faculty collaboration, wisdom-sharing. (From the Six Elements' Element 5 positives.) - Negative keywords present: No explicit negatives observed in public materials.

Why this rating - The materials convey a strong emphasis on virtuous, knowledgeable faculty who guide formation, with explicit leadership statements about cultivating a respectful, known community; this aligns with classical norms of the faculty as living exemplars and mentors.

Citations: Leadership language; faculty pages; board presence.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school communicates opportunities to engage families through community events, open houses, and inquiries; there is an emphasis on belonging to a faith-based community and public-facing sharing of school life. - The materials emphasize partnership with families in a general sense (e.g., "Join Our Community," leadership statements about "cultivating a community where every student is known, valued, and encouraged to thrive"), but explicit language about parents as co-educators or formal parent-formation programs is less evident in the public-facing materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): partnership with families, family involvement, parent formation, parental engagement, school-parent synergy, community of learners (from the Six Elements' Element 6 positives). - Negative keywords present: The site does not clearly present negative indicators; however, explicit language about parents as co-teachers or formal parental formation programs would strengthen alignment. The current public materials show more open-house and engagement signals than a formal, explicit parent-formed role.

Why this rating - There is clear movement toward family involvement and community warmth, but explicit, systematic partnership with parents as co-educators and formal parent formation content is not as strongly articulated as the canonical Element 6 signals. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is warranted for this category.

Citations: Community language; open houses; leadership statements.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school increases explicit, explicit articulation of parents as co-educators (e.g., a formal statement about parental partnership, home catechesis, parent study groups, and family formation efforts) with concrete programs and timelines, Element 6 would move toward CLASSICAL.
 - If the school further foregrounds a documented "living curriculum" language about teachers as models of virtue and mentorship in public-facing materials (e.g., explicit portraits of teacher formation, mentorship structures, and professional formation), Element 5 would move toward CLASSICAL.
 - If additional explicit language or artifacts show a deeper embrace of reverent liturgical practices and sacramental formation as a consistent curricular thread (e.g., regular liturgical scheduling, chapel calendars, and liturgical year integration in more pages), Element 1 would more fully saturate the religious-metaphysical foundation, reinforcing the CLASSICAL rating.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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